

ferred onto a Palmtop. A small mirror for a self portrait is also provided.

The menu is quite intuitive. One unique feature of the 535 is the Be DJ mixer functionality, which allows editing of pre-existing tunes, and composing of new tunes for your phone. We tried our hands at it, and found that it's too limited to warrant the 'DJ' label. Still, it's a welcome change. Connectivity comes in the form of infrared and GPRS.

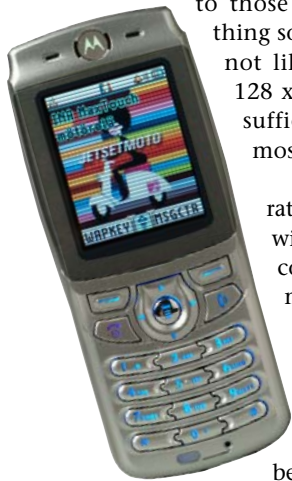
Motorola E365

Price: Rs 12,995 **B**

The Motorola E365 comes for Rs 12,995, which is good for a handset that has a camera and five preloaded games, and supports GPRS and WAP.

The screen is very hard to read when the backlight is not on. This is the case even in a sufficiently lit room.

This phone sports an 'industrial' type of design with a dual-tone body colour, making it more appealing to those who prefer something sober. Women might not like the design. The 128 x 160, 65K screen is sufficiently large for most tasks.



The phone has a rather cramped keypad with round, contoured keys that make it difficult to type. They also don't offer smooth tactile feel, and so typing long messages can be tiring.

The camera at the back is 640 x 480. It's intelligently shielded from damage, because it's located in a small cavity. A lens cover is also provided.

Two shortcut keys are provided on the screen for messages and WAP. However, the menu structure is such that getting to the Phonebook requires a total of five clicks. To avoid these five clicks, the phone has a function called Turbo Dial. It lets you access numbers by pressing a digit from 0 to 9 for more than two seconds. You can store ten numbers this way.

Geo GV880

Price: Rs 24,999 **C-**

If you are looking for a phone with an unusual look, then the GV880 might appeal to you. It's very untraditionally square and is coupled with a pearly white clamshell design that's quite aesthetic in its appeal. Had it not been for its antenna, it could have been easily passed off as a vanity box. It also has a mirror-like surface on the flip (to check if the lips are done well perhaps!). Behind this is the 256-colour OLED screen that shows signal strength, battery life, etc.

Open the flip and you are greeted with a 128x160-pixel 65K-colour TFT screen that occupies the place most.

The keypads spread themselves all over the other flip. The blue backlight makes the keypad look very soothing especially

in the dark, but the keys are not finger-friendly—typing text messages is a headache.

Its menu is not difficult to use. Also, you can use the four-way key and 2 function buttons to invoke commonly used features, but sadly these shortcuts cannot be customised.

The camera is another interesting add-on. It's placed at the bottom-left corner and has a single, multiple (9-images) option and a video-shoot option. Video recordings can only be 10 seconds—sound not included.

Coming to messaging, the T9 is not that good and automatic capitalisation is nowhere in sight. This means more clicks to switch between capital and small letters.

Owing to its small size, and different design, the GEO GV880 is more of a life style product rather than a productivity tool, which is perhaps the reason behind the lack of features such as Bluetooth, IR, etc. At Rs 24,999, it appears to be a phone for the Page 3 glitterati!



Pantech G500

Price: Rs 25,995 **C-**

The G500's clamshell design coupled with its silver body will appeal to the fairer sex instantly. Its external LCD is one of the biggest to be found on any flip phone. Supporting 262K-colours, the 128x128-pixel

screen comes in handy to click self-portrait photos, read SMSes and peruse the call list.

The keypad offers good tactile feel, but the button layout fails to evoke interest. There's hardly any space between the navigation keys and a function key.

Its messaging system is in a mess. The T9 input is not very effective and capital letters are not detected automatically. This means you have to change the letters from lowercase to uppercase manually.

The internal LCD is 128 x 160 pixels in size, and supports 262K colours as well.

The VGA camera is placed at the top of the flip. A flash light is also bundled along. The only sore point is its protruding antenna which makes it a bit cumbersome to carry around.

The Pantech G500 does have a voice-recording facility, but sadly, the recording can only be 30 seconds long. There's just one game bundled along.

The accompanying CD-ROM has additional ringtones and images. Also in the bundle were a serial data cable, handsfree set and an extra battery. At Rs 25,995, it's just too costly, considering the fact that it lacks connectivity options such as Bluetooth.

